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<https://russelldudek.github.io/Vanta/>

Ship People automation with a warranty.

Interview thesis brief for Vanta's People Automation & AI Partner
role: actual work, operating tensions, evidence transfer, first-90-days
posture, and executive discovery questions.

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Executive summary

Actual work: establish an embedded automation product practice for Recruiting and People that converts fragmented demand and one-off ideas into reliable, documented, adopted workflows—without creating shadow architecture or obscuring human accountability.

Candidate thesis: Ship People automation with a warranty. Every workflow should declare its promise, source of truth, mechanism choice, retained human authority, failure path, steward, operating proof, and maintenance decision.

Company moment

Trust as continuous work

Vanta’s public product direction connects compliance, risk, proof, integrations, agentic workflows, and continuously refreshed context. The People role is a parallel internal challenge: connect work, knowledge, systems, and ownership so trust is maintained in operation rather than asserted at launch.

Growth and internal leverage

Vanta’s public growth and expanded AI platform increase the importance of a hiring engine and People infrastructure that can scale without adding proportional manual coordination or inconsistent execution.

AI fluency with judgment

The job description explicitly seeks hands-on building plus sound judgment about when AI is appropriate versus standard automation, scripts, or process redesign.

Architecture without shadow ownership

The role builds inside Recruiting and People, partners with People Systems on architecture and data structure, and does not own system configuration. Boundary clarity is part of the product.

Operating tensions

Tension	What each side protects	Operating response
Speed × durability	Learning velocity × maintainability	Thin slices, launch warranty, named steward, maintenance review.
Automation × human authority	Efficiency × fairness/context/accountability	Explicit action boundary and exception ownership.
Embedded autonomy × architecture	Bias for action × People Systems integrity	Interface contracts, source-of-truth rules, escalation path.
Tool exploration × coherence	Market learning × stable operating model	One portfolio standard across Dust, Claude, Zapier, scripts, and ATS workflows.
Launch volume × maintenance capacity	Opportunity capture × reliability	Scale, repair, human-led, or retire decisions based on evidence.

Immediate contribution

Bring direct AI-workflow building, operating discipline, human-in-the-loop judgment, quality and recovery mechanisms, cross-functional translation, standard work, and adoption practice. Learn Vanta’s Recruiting domain and tool patterns through real pod work, then ship a bounded production slice with existing owners rather than waiting for a perfect map.

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People Automation Warranty

WORKFLOW PROMISE	The user and business outcome the workflow should improve.
SOURCE OF TRUTH	The system, field, knowledge, owner, and freshness requirement that ground action.
MECHANISM FIT	Process redesign, deterministic automation, script/integration, AI, or a bounded combination.
HUMAN AUTHORITY	What may act, what requires approval, and what remains a human decision.
FAILURE + STEWARDSHIP	How it stops safely, exposes exceptions, assigns recovery, preserves context, and remains owned.
PROOF + DECISION	Baseline, units, experience, adoption, economics, and a scale / repair / human-led / retire decision.

Evidence-to-contribution map

Verified evidence	How it contributes at Vanta
Vape-Jet: hands-on AI-first transformation across operations, quality, support, customer success, engineering issue flow, ERP, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, training, and accountability.	Embedded workflow building, system handoffs, adoption, operating feedback, and maintenance discipline.
DudeWorth: AI readiness, opportunity evaluation, agentic workflow patterns, retrieval, human judgment, evaluation, escalation, and governance.	Mechanism choice, agent architecture thinking, knowledge grounding, practical controls, and value prioritization.
Amazon: launch, standard work, labor planning, visibility, escalation, Lean/Gemba, customer-backward execution.	High-velocity operating discipline, measurable flow, frontline usability, and learning from exceptions.
Compunetics: quality systems, root cause, engineering-to-operations translation, process controls, high-reliability execution.	Durable production patterns, technical partnership, failure learning, traceability, and accountable change.

Executive questions

1. Where is the most expensive mismatch between speed and consistency in the hiring funnel?
2. Which existing automations are valuable but difficult to maintain?
3. What People decisions must remain explicitly human even when AI can assist?
4. How are ownership boundaries divided among Recruiting, People Operations, and People Systems?
5. What evidence should determine whether a workflow scales across pods?
6. Where does the knowledge base fail agents: structure, freshness, permission, retrieval, or ownership?

Public sources

Vanta About: <https://www.vanta.com/company/about> · Careers and operating principles: <https://www.vanta.com/company/careers> · Agentic Trust Platform: <https://www.vanta.com/resources/agentic-trust-platform> · Vanta AI: <https://www.vanta.com/products/ai> · Job posting: <https://jobs.ashbyhq.com/vanta/dad058bc-c45a-4723-9e22-405b65c07a3a>